



1 YOGI ADITYANATH, *Uttar Pradesh*
40% [27.1%]

BANDEEP SINGH

Most popular CM (across India)

Respondents across all states were asked to rate the best performing CM in the country

him the most popular chief minister in a home state by a huge margin—15 percentile points ahead of his next competitor.

The MOTN numbers suggest that the BJP too has found two chief ministers who have often made national news for their decisive style of governance, albeit mired in controversies. Uttar Pradesh CM Yogi Adityanath remains the most popular choice of respondents across the country, the fifth time in a row since the August 2020 MOTN. In fact, the popularity rating of 'bulldozer baba', a popular moniker given to Yogi for his government's penchant for razing the homes of people accused of crimes, has gone up—40 per cent respondents now find him the best chief minister of the country against 27 per cent six months ago.

Another CM who has been using the bulldozer model is Assam's Himanta Biswa Sarma who has emerged as the second most popular chief minister in a home state. His popularity ratings have also gone up—from 56 per cent respondents in January 2022 to 63 per cent now.

But the party also has reasons to worry. The BJP is in power in 13 states, yet the MOTN finds that 60 per cent of the top 10 most popular CMs across India and top 10 most popular in their home states are not from the party. The saffron party also needs to worry about the governance model of Delhi CM Arvind Kejriwal. The second most popular chief minister across the country and fourth most popular in a home state—56 per cent expressed satisfaction at his performance—the AAP supremo is now hoping to expand beyond Delhi and Punjab. His recent foray into Goa may have ended in disaster, but that has not deterred him as he prepares for battle in Modi's home bastion Gujarat. His national ambition is further bolstered by a sharp decline in the popularity of Mamata Banerjee. While only 9 per cent find her the country's best chief minister, she is not even among the top 10 most popular CMs in home states. ■



2 ARVIND KEJRIWAL, *Delhi*
22% [20%]



3 MAMATA BANERJEE, *West Bengal*
9% [11%]



4 M.K. STALIN, *Tamil Nadu*
5% [7%]



5 Y.S. JAGAN MOHAN REDDY, *Andhra Pradesh*
4% [3%]



6 NAVEEN PATNAIK, *Odisha*
4% [3%]



7 HIMANTA BISWA SARMA, *Assam*
2% [1%]



8 SHIVRAJ SINGH CHOUHAN, *Madhya Pradesh*
1% [1%]



9 BHUPESH BAGHEL, *Chhattisgarh*
1% [1%]



10 BASAVARAJ BOMMAI, *Karnataka*
1% [1%]

Rest Others, DK/ CS (Don't know/ can't say); figures in [] are from Jan. 2022 MOTN
Note: All 119,537 respondents across states were given a list of the 30 chief ministers in India. The ratings are their perception of who the No. 1 chief minister in India is. Figures have been rounded off